



Burundi

Small, densely populated and landlocked, Burundi lies just south of the equator, on the Nile–Congo watershed in central Africa. Its people have the world's lowest per capita income.



GEOGRAPHY

Hilly with high plateaus in center and savanna in the east. Great Rift Valley on western side.



CLIMATE

Temperate, with high humidity. Heavy and frequent rainfall, mostly October–May. Highlands have frost.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Burundi has been riven by ethnic conflict between majority Hutu and the Tutsi, who controlled the army – with repeated large-scale massacres: hundreds of thousands of people have died since 1993. The constitution now guarantees an ethnic balance in the government and army. Twa pygmies were not involved in the conflict.



INSIGHT: *Burundi's fertility rate is one of the highest in Africa. On average, women have seven children*



THE ECONOMY

Overwhelmingly agricultural economy, mostly subsistence. Small quantities of gold and tungsten. Potential of oil in Lake Tanganyika. Little prospect of lasting stability.



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Republic of Burundi

DATE OF FORMATION: 1962

CAPITAL: Bujumbura

POPULATION: 8.3 million

TOTAL AREA: 10,745 sq. miles
(27,830 sq. km)

DENSITY: 838 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Kirundi*, French*,
Kiswahili

RELIGIONS: Christian (mainly Roman Catholic)
60%, traditional beliefs 39%,
Muslim 1%

ETHNIC MIX: Hutu 85%, Tutsi 14%, Twa 1%

GOVERNMENT: Presidential system

CURRENCY: Burundi franc = 100 centimes